HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

HEIRSTONE CONSULTING RESEARCH | 2026

RETAIL REAL ESTATE IN AFRICA

The market is the anchor

Open-air markets, shopping malls and who wins retail real estate in North and Sub-Saharan Africa



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THE REPORT IN SIX NUMBERS

72%

of Nigerian retail sales go through open-air markets. Supermarkets take 3% (USDA FAS, 2024).

8,700

trading places per hectare designed into Abidjan's Forum des marchés, against about 32 shops per hectare of lettable floor at Accra Mall (Heirstone analysis of published figures).

24%

of previous income earned, on average, by 25 street vendors surveyed after their move out of Kejetia, Kumasi, for its rebuild (WIEGO, 2020).

−40%

change in Ikeja City Mall's US dollar value from its 2019 valuation to the value implied by its 2024 sale; reported vacancy stayed at 2.1% or less.

4.85%

vacancy at Kumasi City Mall in June 2024, down from 32.2% a year earlier, as Melcom fitted out the whole unit Game had left (Hyprop).

115 m²

of mall space per 1,000 residents in Greater Cairo, against about 12 m² for the two largest malls in Accra (Knight Frank; Heirstone analysis).

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises developers, investors, retailers and governments across the Middle East and Africa on markets, feasibility and specialised real estate. This report uses public information current in 2026: landlord and retailer filings, government and multilateral statistics, press reporting, academic and NGO studies, and published broker data.

Figures that rest on a single secondary source are attributed in the text. Where we combine published numbers into a new measure, such as traders per hectare or capital per trading unit, the calculation is labelled as Heirstone analysis and its inputs are shown.

Local-currency amounts are converted at the World Bank official exchange rate, annual average, for the year stated.

WHAT WE FOUND

Africa's largest retail real estate is the public market. Malls work when they are built to its terms.

Outside South Africa, formal retail is a thin layer over a market economy. Most trade happens in markets run or regulated by public bodies, at densities no mall approaches, among traders who pay daily fees. The malls that have held their value are those whose rent is set in the currency their tenants earn and whose anchor space a local chain can take over.

1 Markets still carry the trade.

Open-air markets take 72% of Nigeria's retail sales and supermarkets 3%, according to USDA FAS. Small grocers hold 83% of food retail in Ghana and 63% in Côte d'Ivoire. Nigeria's six leading supermarket chains run about 90 outlets between them; one market in Aba has more than 37,000 shops, according to Nigeria's Rural Electrification Agency.

2 Measured as property, the market is dense and public.

Abidjan's Forum des marchés was built for about 8,700 places per hectare; Accra Mall has about 32 shops per hectare of lettable floor. All 15 markets in our register with a recorded owner or manager are held, run or regulated by a public body, and street-vendor tolls were estimated at 70% of Kumasi's own revenue.

3 Rebuilds on the original site have the best record.

Of 12 market redevelopments we classified, the three rebuilt in place reopened as working markets. Kejetia in Kumasi added 8,420 lettable spaces at US$23,500 to US$30,800 each, depending on the published cost, with 500 tabletop places for some 5,000 street vendors; vendors surveyed after their move earned about a quarter of their previous income.

4 Malls lose value through currency while staying full.

Ikeja City Mall in Lagos reported vacancy of 2.1% or less from 2021 to 2024, yet its value fell from US$141m in 2019 to the US$85m implied by its 2024 sale. Its rents were indexed to the dollar, and the naira lost 79% of its dollar value over 2019 to 2024. Hyprop's exit, planned for 12 to 18 months, took five years and was paid in shares.

5 Anchors leave; local chains fill boxes they can take.

Game left Ghana on 31 December 2022. Within 18 months Kumasi City Mall's vacancy fell from 32.2% to 4.85% as Melcom took Game's whole unit, while at Accra Mall the former Game space was let temporarily and then split between Melcom and Decathlon. In Uganda, which Shoprite left in 2021, Carrefour's franchisee agreed to take over its leases.

6 North Africa is a mall market, and Greater Cairo's supply is large and still growing.

Greater Cairo has about 2.6 million m^2 of lifestyle mall space across 82 developments, about 115 m^2 per 1,000 residents, and added 183,730 m^2 in 2025. Morocco's Aradei reports 97% occupancy across 474,000 m^2 in 23 cities.

WHAT IT MEANS

CITY GOVERNMENTS

Count every trader, including tabletop and street vendors, before design. Rebuild in place and keep trade at ground level; the fee base depends on the traders who return.

MALL DEVELOPERS AND OWNERS

Set rent in local currency or cap the dollar indexation. Build anchor boxes that a local chain can take whole, or split without structural works.

RETAILERS AND CONSUMER GOODS

Plan distribution through markets and their wholesalers. Enter through franchise and local partners, who have outlasted owned subsidiaries.

INVESTORS, DFIS AND LENDERS

Price the currency before the occupancy. Back operating platforms and market-site partnerships, and budget for exits that take years.



CHAPTER 1

The trade stays in the market

Formal retail in Africa outside South Africa is a minority channel almost everywhere it has been measured. The market, with its stalls, tables and kiosks, still carries the trade.

USDA FAS, in its 2024 Nigeria retail foods report, puts open-air markets at 72% of retail sales, small grocers and convenience stores at 25% and supermarkets at 3%. In Ghana small local grocers hold 83% of food retail. In Côte d'Ivoire they hold 63%, supermarkets 22% and hypermarkets 2%, and the informal sector accounts for about three-quarters of the market. Egypt's small grocers have about 60% of food retail, more than US$13bn of sales.

The usual comparison is South Africa, where McKinsey estimated in 2015 that supermarkets had about 75% of grocery sales. The academic 'supermarket revolution' literature of the 2000s expected the rest of the continent to follow, as Latin America had. Formal grocery has grown: Euromonitor recorded a 24% rise in Nigerian supermarket sales in 2023. It has grown from so low a base that the market remains the main channel.

This report treats the market as real estate. Chapter 2 measures it: density, unit size, ownership and the fees it pays. Chapter 3 reviews 12 attempts to rebuild markets and what happened to their traders. Chapters 4 and 5 turn to the mall and to the currency and anchor problems behind the malls that struggled in the past decade. Chapter 6 sets out how North Africa differs from anglophone and francophone Sub-Saharan Africa, and chapter 7 what each audience should do.

3%

supermarkets' share of Nigerian retail sales (USDA FAS, 2024 report)

75%

supermarkets' share of grocery in South Africa (McKinsey, 2015), the continent's outlier

60%

small local grocers' share of food retail in Egypt, more than US$13bn of sales (USDA FAS)

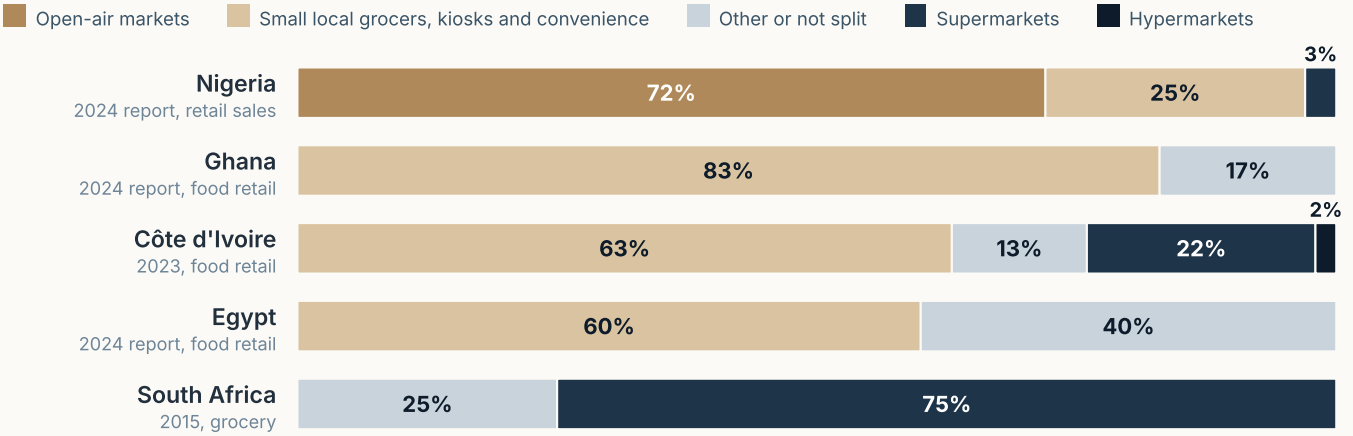
CHANNELS

Outside South Africa, supermarkets are a minority channel in every country with published shares

EXHIBIT 1

Supermarkets hold 3% of Nigeria's retail sales and 22% of Côte d'Ivoire's food retail; South Africa is the exception

Share of retail or food retail sales by channel, %, latest published year. Definitions differ between country reports.



Source: USDA FAS GAIN, Retail Foods Annual reports: Nigeria NI2024-0014 (3 Oct 2024), Ghana GH2024-0011 (2024), Côte d'Ivoire IV2024-0009 (20 Sep 2024), Egypt EG2024-0024 (2024); McKinsey & Company, 'Winning in Africa's consumer market' (Jul 2015). **Heirstone analysis:** grey segments are residuals (100 minus published shares) and may include modern formats; Ghana's 17% is USDA's combined share for supermarkets, hypermarkets and other retailers.

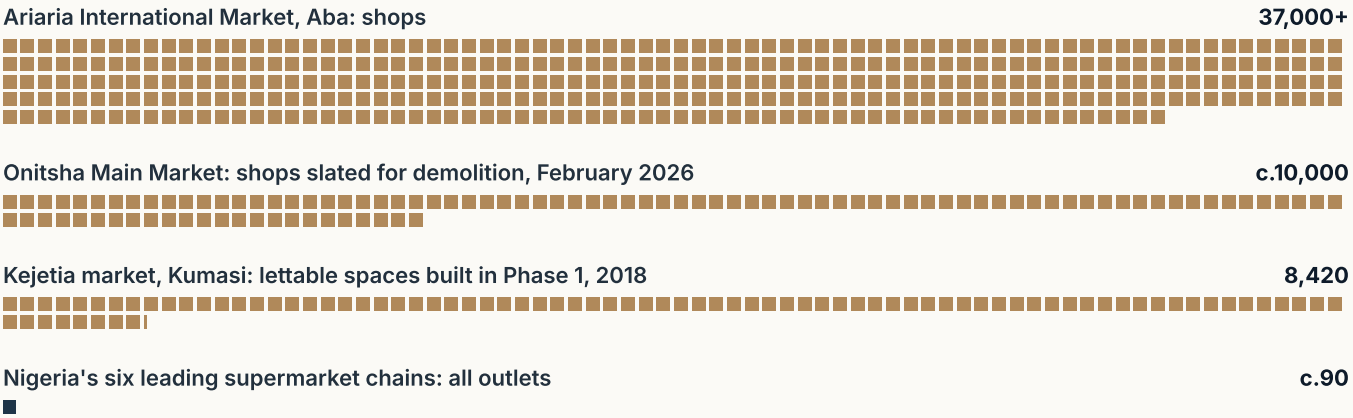
The definitions differ. USDA's Nigeria report separates open-air markets from small grocers; its Ghana and Côte d'Ivoire reports fold markets, kiosks and independents into 'small local grocers'. The direction does not change. In Côte d'Ivoire, where the four largest chains (Prosuma, Carrefour, Auchan and CDCI) take about 35% of retail revenues, USDA still puts the informal sector at about 75% of the market.

Counting points of sale makes the gap plainer. USDA lists Nigeria's leading chains as ShopRite (20+ outlets), Justrite (18), FoodCo (18), Market Square (15+), SPAR and Park 'N' Shop (14) and Prince Ebeano (5): about 90 stores. A single market in Aba, Ariaria, has more than 37,000 shops, according to Nigeria's Rural Electrification Agency.

EXHIBIT 2

Nigeria's six leading supermarket chains have about 90 outlets between them; one market in Aba is recorded with more than 37,000 shops

Trading units, number. Each square = 100 units. A supermarket is far larger than a stall: the exhibit compares points of sale, not floor area.



Source: USDA FAS GAIN NI2024-0014 (2024), Table 2; Rural Electrification Agency (2019); Vanguard (2026); Ghanaian Times (2019). Market figures are single secondary sources. **Heirstone analysis.**

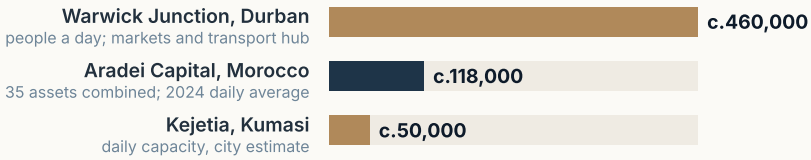
SCALE

Markets work as wholesale hubs, and their workforces grew while Kenya's biggest chains failed

EXHIBIT 3

Durban's Warwick Junction draws about four times as many people a day as a listed Moroccan landlord's 35 assets combined

People a day, latest available year. Market figures are orders of magnitude from single secondary sources.

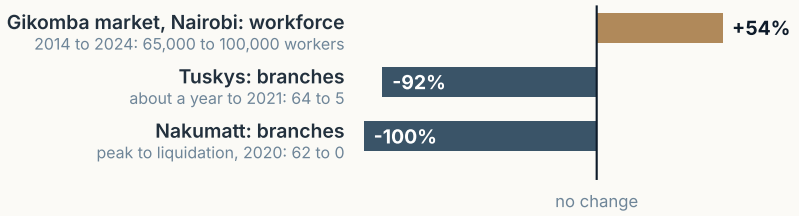


Source: Project for Public Spaces, 'Warwick Junction' (2015, updated 2024); WIEGO, Okoye (2020), p.10, citing the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly's estimate of daily carrying capacity; Aradei Capital, corporate website (2024 data, accessed 2026). **Heirstone analysis:** Aradei daily average = 43m visits ÷ 365.

EXHIBIT 4

Nairobi's Gikomba market added 35,000 workers in a decade in which two of Kenya's biggest supermarket chains collapsed

Change over the period shown, %



Source: Reuters via Fin24 (2014) and The Eastleigh Voice (2024), citing Nairobi's city government; Citizen Digital (2021); Daily Nation (2019); Daily Monitor (2020). Single secondary sources. **Heirstone analysis.**

8,000+

people employed in Lagos' Computer Village, a phone and computer market, according to its dealers' association (Vanguard, 2021)

40%

of the second-hand clothing reaching Kantamanto, Accra, leaves as waste, on The Or Foundation's estimate, which the dealers' association disputes (Fashion Dive, 2024)

6

branches of the collapsed Nakumatt bought by Naivas in 2019

A large African market is a wholesale and logistics business as much as a retail one. Kantamanto in Accra is a hub for imported second-hand clothing, and Lagos' Computer Village, a market for phones and computers, employs more than 8,000 people, according to its dealers' association.

Footfall figures for markets are rare and mostly single-sourced, so we read them as orders of magnitude. Durban's Warwick Junction, nine markets around a transport interchange, sees about 460,000 people a day, according to Project for Public Spaces. Kumasi's city government put the daily capacity of its central market at about 50,000 people. Aradei Capital's 35 Moroccan assets recorded 43 million visits in 2024, about 118,000 a day across the whole portfolio.

The workforce numbers point the same way. Nairobi's city government put about 65,000 people working in Gikomba in 2014 and almost 100,000 in 2024. Over a similar period Nakumatt, which had 62 branches in four countries at its peak, shut dozens of outlets from 2017 and its creditors voted to liquidate it in 2020, and Tuskys fell from 64 branches to five. Naivas, which had 43 stores in 2017, bought Nakumatt's last six branches.

CHAPTER 2

02

A hectare of traders

Measured as property, a large African market is the densest retail real estate on the continent, and wherever its manager is on record, that manager is a public body.

1.2 m^2

of site per trading place at Abidjan's Forum des marchés (Heirstone analysis)

310 m^2

average lettable area per unit at Accra Mall, anchors included (Heirstone analysis)

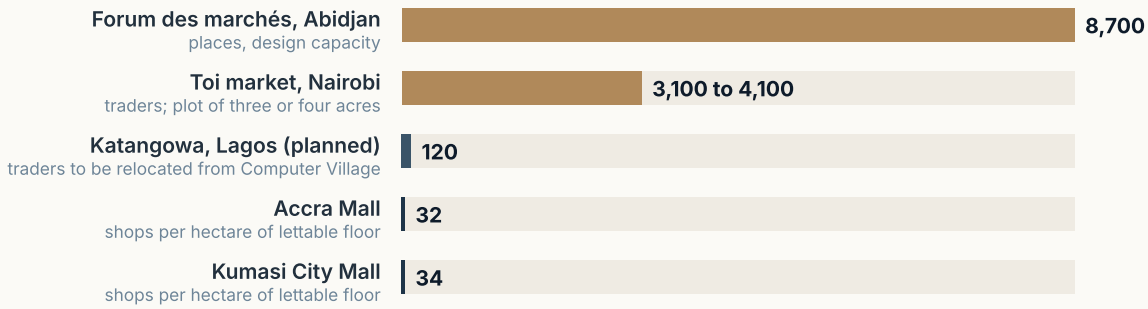
According to a 2009 study at the Université de Cocody, Abidjan's Forum des marchés, built from 1997 after fires in 1989 and 1993 damaged the old grand marché in Adjamé, covers 1.5 hectares on two levels with capacity for 13,000 places: about 8,700 per hectare, or 1.2 m^2 of site for each place. Nairobi's Toi market had about 5,000 traders on a plot reported as three acres by The Standard in 2018 and four acres by The Star in 2019, or 3,100 to 4,100 traders per hectare.

Malls let space in units two orders of magnitude larger. Accra Mall opened in 2008 with 65 line shops and two anchors on 20,619 m^2 of lettable area, about 310 m^2 per unit on average. Kumasi City Mall has 61 shops on 18,000 m^2. Counted per hectare of lettable floor, which flatters the mall, both have 32 to 34 shops per hectare. Katangowa, the site proposed for Lagos' Computer Village, was described in 2014 as a 25-hectare market for the 3,000-plus traders the state planned to move: about 120 per hectare, a seventieth of the Forum's design density.

EXHIBIT 5

Abidjan's Forum des marchés was designed for more than 250 times as many trading units per hectare as Accra Mall has shops

Trading units per hectare. Markets: per hectare of site. Malls: per hectare of gross lettable area (GLA), which overstates mall density.



Source: Université de Cocody, 'Étude sur le forum des marchés d'Adjamé' (2009); The Standard (2018); The Star (2019); Wanted in Africa (2014); Pulse Ghana (2017); Bloomberg (2012); Atterbury, Kumasi City Mall, with Accra Mall GLA (accessed 2026). **Heirstone analysis:** units ÷ area; Toi converted from three and four acres; Accra Mall counts 65 line shops and two anchors. Single secondary sources (grade C).

THE HEIRSTONE MARKET AND MALL REGISTER, PART A

Twenty markets: mostly unmeasured, and public wherever the manager is known

The register records every market for which at least one figure could be verified in public sources; part B, the 27 malls, appears in Exhibits 20 and 21. The gaps are part of the finding. These are among the largest commercial properties in their cities, and their area, trader numbers and turnover are rarely published.

EXHIBIT 6

Areas and trader counts are published for only a handful of the continent's largest markets; every recorded owner or manager is a public body or works with one

Selected markets, latest available figures to 2026: site area, trading units, traders or visitors, owner or manager, latest dated event. n/v = not verified in public sources (not zero). * MyJoyOnline (23 Jan 2025), reporting the traders' association; 3News counted over 100 shops on the day of the fire.

MARKET	AREA, HA	TRADING UNITS	TRADERS, WORKERS OR VISITORS	OWNER OR MANAGER	LATEST DATED EVENT
NORTH AFRICA					
Ataba market, Cairo	n/v	n/v	n/v	State	Project inaugurated, 2025
Derb Ghallef, Casablanca	n/v	c.700 premises (1982)	1,387 people (2007)	n/v	Study count, 2007
Medina souks, Marrakesh	n/v	n/v	n/v	Public realm	Square renovation, MAD160m, 2025
Fès el Bali, Fès	280	n/v	n/v	ADER-Fès (state agency)	World Heritage listing, 1981
WEST AFRICA: ANGLOPHONE					
Ariaria International, Aba	n/v	37,000+ shops	n/v	Abia State	Section remodelled, 2022
Main Market, Onitsha	n/v	c.10,000 shops to go	n/v	Anambra State	Demolition planned, 2026
Computer Village, Lagos	n/v	n/v	8,000+ employed	Lagos State	Move proposed 2017, not done
Alaba International, Lagos	n/v	n/v	n/v	n/v	Fire, 2023
Balogun, Lagos	n/v	n/v	n/v	n/v	Fires 2019 and 2020
Tejuosho, Lagos	n/v	4,000+ shops (new complex)	n/v	Lagos State (BOT lease)	Complex opened, 2014
Oshodi, Lagos	n/v	Almost 600 shops (new site)	n/v	Lagos State	Demolished, 2016
Kejetia, Kumasi	n/v	8,420 lettable spaces	20,000 vendors; 50,000 capacity	KMA	Fire, 2025
Kantamanto, Accra	n/v	7,000+ shops lost*	Nearly 30,000 traders*	AMA (tolls)	Toll from 2026
Agbogbloshie, Accra	n/v	n/v	n/v	State	Demolition began 2021
WEST AND CENTRAL AFRICA: FRANCOPHONE					
Forum des marchés, Abidjan	1.5	13,000 places	n/v	n/v	Built from 1997
Dantokpa, Cotonou	20+	n/v	n/v	SOGEMA (state)	Wholesale move planned, 2017
EAST AFRICA					
Gikomba, Nairobi	n/v	c.10,000 shops and stalls	c.100,000 workers	County; national govt	Traders relocated, 2026
Toi, Nairobi	1.2 to 1.6	3,500 stalls	c.5,000 traders	Nairobi County	Fire, 2019; rebuild promised
Kariakoo, Dar es Salaam	n/v	n/v	1,500 cleared to return	Public corporation	Reopened, 2026
SOUTHERN AFRICA					
Warwick Junction, Durban	n/v	9 markets	6,000 to 8,000 vendors	n/v	Mall plan opposed, 2009

Source: Heirstone Market and Mall Register (2026), compiled from: WIEGO, Okoye (2020); FAO and CIRAD (1998); Benin Ministry of Decentralisation; Beninsite (2017); CESEM, Economia (2008); UNESCO; Le360 (2025); Rural Electrification Agency (2019); Peoples Gazette (2022); Vanguard (2014 to 2026); Sahara Reporters (2016); Channels TV (2019); Nairametrics (2020); Ghanaian Times (2019); MyJoyOnline (2025, 2026); Université de Cocody (2009); Reuters via Fin24 (2014); The Eastleigh Voice (2024); The Standard (2018); The Star (2019, 2026); Daily Nation (2026); Africanews and Pan African Visions (2026); Project for Public Spaces; Markets of Warwick; Egypt Independent (2025). Most entries rest on a single secondary source (grade C).

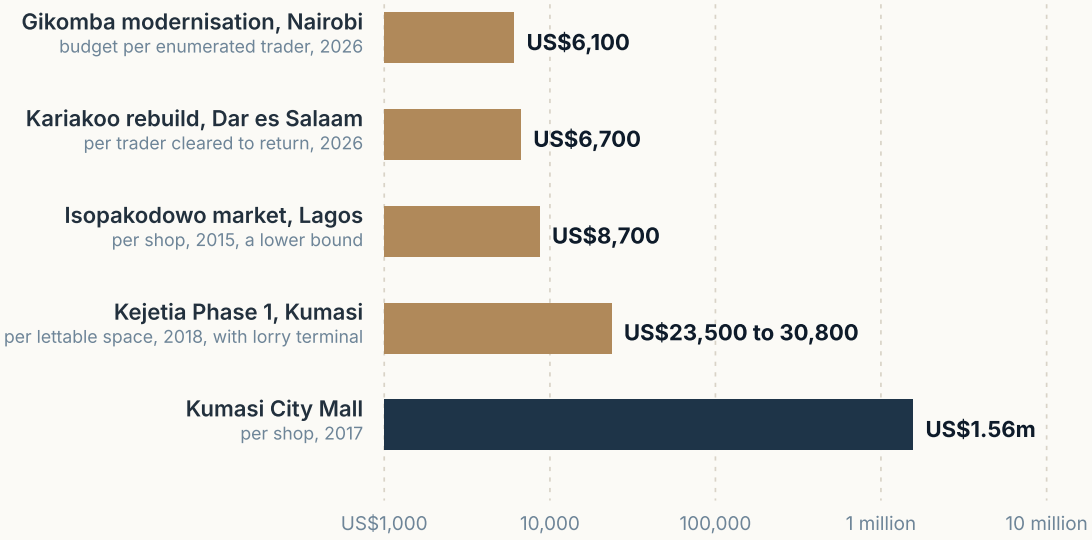
CAPITAL

In Kumasi, about US$95m built 61 mall shops; US$198m to US$259m built 8,420 market spaces

EXHIBIT 7

Per trading unit, a Kumasi mall shop cost 50 to 66 times as much as a market space built in the same city over the same years

Capital cost per trading unit, US$, log scale. Units differ in size: a Kumasi City Mall shop averages about 300 m² of lettable area. Local currency at the World Bank official annual average rate for the year shown.



Source: Africanews (2026); The Star (2026), budget not outturn, KSh5bn at the 2025 average of 129.3 per US$; Vanguard (2016), over N1bn for almost 600 shops, at the 2015 average of 192.4 per US$ (a lower bound); Kejetia: US$198m announced for Phase 1 (Graphic Online, 2015) to US$259.4m reported cost (Graphic Online, 2019), for 8,420 lettable spaces (Ghanaian Times, 2019); Kumasi City Mall: US$95m (GNA via Citi FM, 2017) for 61 shops (Atterbury); World Bank WDI, PA.NUS.FCRF. **Heirstone analysis.**

Kumasi offers a rare same-city comparison. Between June 2014 and April 2017 Atterbury built Kumasi City Mall, 18,000 m² with 61 shops, at a cost reported at about US$95m. Between December 2015 and November 2018 Kejetia market and lorry terminal were rebuilt for the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly, with 8,420 lettable spaces. Phase 1 was announced at US$198m in 2015, and Graphic Online reported in 2019 that it had cost US$259.4m. Per trading unit the mall cost about US$1.56m and the market US$23,500 to US$30,800, a ratio of roughly 50 to 66.

The comparison is not like for like. The market figure includes a lorry terminal, and each mall shop holds far more floor, so the ratio overstates the difference in cost per square metre. The difference in output is plain: 61 places to trade against 8,420. Other market projects in our record came in lower still, at about US$6,700 per trader cleared to return at Kariakoo (TSh28bn, reported by Africanews as US$10m) and about US$6,100 per enumerated trader in Gikomba's 2026 budget of KSh5bn.

For a city government the measure that matters is cost per trader who comes back. A market rebuild spends tens of thousands of dollars per trader, and the authority's return on it arrives as fees from the traders who return. Chapter 3 shows how often that number falls short.

Mall costs set a high bar for rents. On its reported cost of US$95m, Kumasi City Mall cost about US$5,300 per m² of lettable area in 2017. At a 9% yield, Knight Frank's 2026 figure for Ghana, it needs about US$40 per m² a month to earn that cost, about 60% of Accra's prime rent (Heirstone analysis). Accra Mall's build cost could not be verified, so it is not compared. Chapter 5 turns that arithmetic into one of five tests.

OWNERSHIP AND FEES

Market tolls weigh heavily in some city budgets

EXHIBIT 8

Daily tolls of a few cents a trader add up to a large share of some city budgets

Selected payments to and from market traders, local currency and US$ equivalent at the World Bank annual average rate for the year shown

MARKET	WHO PAYS	WHO RECEIVES	AMOUNT	US$ EQUIVALENT	WHAT IT SHOWS
Kejetia and Central Market, Kumasi	Street vendors	Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly	GH¢2.00 a day (c.2016)	US$0.51 a day	About 70% of the Assembly's internally generated funds
Dantokpa, Cotonou	Traders	SOGEMA (state company)	Daily sales taxes	n/v	118 SOGEMA agents collected them across the market (1998)
Computer Village, Lagos	Traders	Ikeja Local Government	About N60m a year (2017)	US$196,000 a year	Levies the council expected to lose on relocation
Kantamanto, Accra	Tabletop and open-shed traders	Accra Metropolitan Assembly	GH¢2 a day (from Apr 2026)	US$0.16 a day	100 revenue collectors deployed after the 2025 fire
Gikomba, Nairobi	National government	Relocated traders	KSh5,000 fee and KSh1,500 a month (2026)	US$39 and US$12 a month	State pays temporary-site costs during works
Oshodi to Isopakodowo, Lagos	Relocated traders	Lagos State	N5,000 per shop (2015)	US$26	Price market leaders agreed to pay for a shop at the relocation market
Kejetia, new building	Market	National grid	GH¢5.2m electricity debt (Jun 2022)	US$630,000	Disconnection; power restored after a 20% payment

Source: WIEGO, Okoye (2020), p.10 (GH¢2 = US$0.51 as stated); FAO and CIRAD, 'La consommation et la distribution alimentaire à Cotonou' (1998); Vanguard (2016, 2017); MyJoyOnline (2026); Daily Nation (2026); 3News (2022); World Bank WDI, PA.NUS.FCRF. **Heirstone analysis** for conversions.

Every market in the register with a recorded owner or manager is held, run or regulated by a public body, from the municipal assemblies of Kumasi and Accra to Benin's state market company SOGEMA and Tanzania's Kariakoo Markets Corporation. Tejuosho in Lagos was rebuilt by a private partner under a 25-year build-operate-transfer lease from the state, and at Kejetia the Asantehene, the Ashanti monarch, joined the President in 2019 to break ground on the second phase. The counterparty for any investment in a market site is still a public body.

The fees explain part of the markets' staying power. WIEGO's Kumasi study estimated that street vendors' tolls supplied about 70% of the Metropolitan Assembly's internally generated funds. Ikeja Local Government expected to lose about N60m a year if Computer Village moved. In April 2026, fifteen months after fire destroyed much of Kantamanto, the Accra Metropolitan Assembly deployed 100 collectors to take a GH¢2 daily toll there.

A formal building adds costs that an open market does not carry. In June 2022 the new Kejetia building was cut off from the grid over an electricity debt of GH¢5.2m, and power returned only after a 20% payment. Nairobi's 2026 plan for Gikomba has the state paying relocated traders' temporary-site fee and rent, a cost that most earlier schemes left to the traders.

15 of 15

markets in the register with a recorded owner or manager are held, run or regulated by a public body

70%

of the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly's own revenue estimated to come from street vendors' tolls (WIEGO, 2020)



CHAPTER 3

03

Who comes back after the rebuild

Twelve market redevelopments, from the Adjamé fires of 1989 and 1993 to Onitsha in 2026, have enough public record to judge what happened to the traders.

We sorted them into five outcomes. Three rebuilt the market on its own site and reopened with traders in it: Adjamé's Forum des marchés in Abidjan, Kariakoo in Dar es Salaam and, informally, Derb Ghallef in Casablanca. Two rebuilt the market as lock-up shops, one of them with far less room for street vendors. Two moved or cleared the traders, three were announced and never built, and two are under way in 2026.

The dividing line is where traders stand during and after the works, and at what height. None of the projects that kept trade on the site and at ground level reported losing its traders. Where traders were moved to a new site or asked to climb, the record shows relocation sites that were never built and, at Kejetia, most surveyed vendors leaving the relocation site. At Agbogbloshie, the one cleared site with a later report, scrap workers had returned by 2025.

Fire often sets the timetable. Six markets in the register were rebuilt or replanned after a fire, and in the two completed cases with both dates the rebuild took four and a half to seven years.

HEIRSTONE MARKET REDEVELOPMENT RECORD: OUTCOMES

REBUILT IN PLACE	3
REBUILT AS LOCK-UP SHOPS	2
MOVED OR CLEARED	2
STALLED	3
PENDING, 2026	2

THE RECORD

The Heirstone Market Redevelopment Record

Twelve redevelopment, relocation and post-fire projects at markets in our register, sorted by what happened to the traders. Outcome classes are our classification of the cited facts, not the sources' wording.

EXHIBIT 9

The three markets rebuilt in place reopened as working markets; relocation sites were left by most traders or never built

Market redevelopment projects, 1982 to 2026: trigger, scheme, traders and cost. n/v = not verified.

MARKET	TRIGGER	BUILT OR PLANNED	TRADERS BEFORE AND AFTER	COST
REBUILT IN PLACE 3 PROJECTS				
Forum des marchés, Abidjan	Fires, 1989 and 1993	Two-level market built from 1997 on 1.5 ha	13,000 places (design capacity)	n/v
Kariakoo, Dar es Salaam	Fire, 2021	Six storeys, underground parking for 400+ cars; reopened 2026	1,500 traders cleared to return	TSh28bn; US$10m as reported
Derb Ghallef, Casablanca	Fire, 1982	Traders reinstalled on provisional permits	730 former traders identified after the fire; 1,387 people counted in 2007	n/v
REBUILT AS LOCK-UP SHOPS 2 PROJECTS				
Kejetia Phase 1, Kumasi	Planning	Market and lorry terminal, 2015 to 2018	6,500 traders incl. 5,000 street vendors; 8,420 lettable spaces and 500 tables	US$198m to 259.4m, as published
Tejuosho, Lagos	Fire	Complex under a 25-year BOT lease; first phase opened 2014	4,000+ lock-up and K-clamp shops	n/v
MOVED OR CLEARED 2 PROJECTS				
Oshodi, Lagos	Transport interchange	Demolished 2016; shops offered at Isopakodowo for N5,000	Almost 600 shops at the new market	Over N1bn (over US$5.2m) for the new market
Agbogbloshie, Accra	Environment and planning	Demolition began 2021; onion traders ordered to Adjen Kotoku	Scrap workers back on the site by 2025	n/v
STALLED 3 PROJECTS				
Computer Village, Lagos	Congestion	Move to 25-ha Katangowa site, proposed 2017	3,000+ traders; still in place in 2024	n/v
Toi, Nairobi	Housing	County plan for houses and 3,000 stalls on the plot, 2018	About 5,000 traders; still trading when fire struck in 2019	n/v
Kantamanto, Accra	Fire, 2020	Two-phase shopping complex, announced 2020	Nearly 30,000 traders; not built before the 2025 fire	US$100m bank loan reported by the traders' association (2025)
PENDING, 2026 2 PROJECTS				
Gikomba, Nairobi	River regeneration	Modernisation from 2026; state pays temporary rent	6,372 traders enumerated and relocated	KSh5bn (US$39m)
Main Market, Onitsha	Planning	Demolition of c.10,000 shops on 14-day notice, 2026	n/v	n/v

Source: Heirstone Market Redevelopment Record (2026). WIEGO, Okoye (2020); Université de Cocody (2009); CESEM, Economia (2008); Africanews and Pan African Visions (2026); Ghanaian Times (2019); Graphic Online (2015, 2019); Vanguard (2014, 2016, 2020, 2024, 2026); Wanted in Africa (2014); Citinewsroom (2021); muntaka.com (2021, updated 2025); The Standard (2018); The Star (2019, 2026); Daily Nation (2026); Pulse Ghana (2020); MyJoyOnline (2025). US$ at World Bank annual averages (2015, 2025).

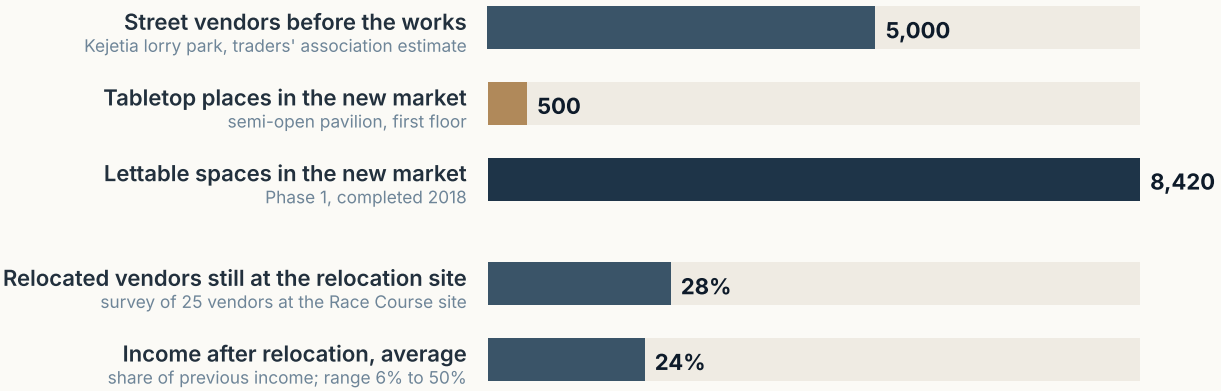
KUMASI AND DAR ES SALAAM

Kejetia added stores and left most street vendors outside; Kariakoo was rebuilt on its own site

EXHIBIT 10

Kejetia's new market had one tabletop place for every ten street vendors, and vendors surveyed after their move earned about a quarter of their previous income

Kejetia market, Kumasi: traders and places, number (top); outcomes for relocated street vendors, % (bottom). Survey period 2016 to 2018.



Source: WIEGO Resource Document 15, Okoye (2020), 'Street Vendor Exclusion in Modern Market Planning: A Case Study from Kumasi, Ghana', pp.6 to 18; Ghanaian Times (2019). Survey sample of 25; read as indicative.

Before works began in December 2015, the Kumasi Metropolitan Assembly estimated about 20,000 vendors in Kumasi Central Market. The Kejetia lorry park beside it held about 6,500 traders, 5,000 of them street vendors, on the traders' association figures used by WIEGO. Phase 1, completed in November 2018 under a Brazilian government loan and built by Contracta Engineering, delivered 8,420 lettable spaces, 6,940 of them lock-up stores (Ghanaian Times, 2019); its cost is published as US$198m (2015 announcement) and US$259.4m (Graphic Online, 2019).

The design gave the street vendors about 500 tabletop places, in a semi-open pavilion on the first floor. Most were moved to a relocation site at the Race Course. When WIEGO's researcher surveyed 25 of them, seven were still there, and they reported earning between 6% and 50% of their previous income, 24% on average. WIEGO's estimate that street vendors' tolls supplied about 70% of the Assembly's own revenue shows what the move put at risk for the city as well.

Kariakoo took the other route. After fire damaged its 1975 building on 10 July 2021, the market was rebuilt on the same site as a six-storey complex with parking for more than 400 cars and a rooftop food court, and reopened on 9 February 2026, four and a half years later. Africanews reported 1,500 traders cleared to return; Pan African Visions put the wider Kariakoo trade at about 30,000 direct vendors. The reported cost of TSh28bn, or US$10m, works out at about US$6,700 per returning trader.

Phase 2 in Kumasi, the Central Market, was launched in 2019 as a €248m project financed by Deutsche Bank with UK Export Finance cover; its progress could not be verified for this report.

10 : 1

street vendors at Kejetia before the works for each tabletop place in the new market (WIEGO)

4.5 years

from the Kariakoo fire (July 2021) to the reopening of the rebuilt market (February 2026)

> *Kejetia gained 8,420 lettable spaces. Its 5,000 street vendors were offered 500 tables on the first floor.*

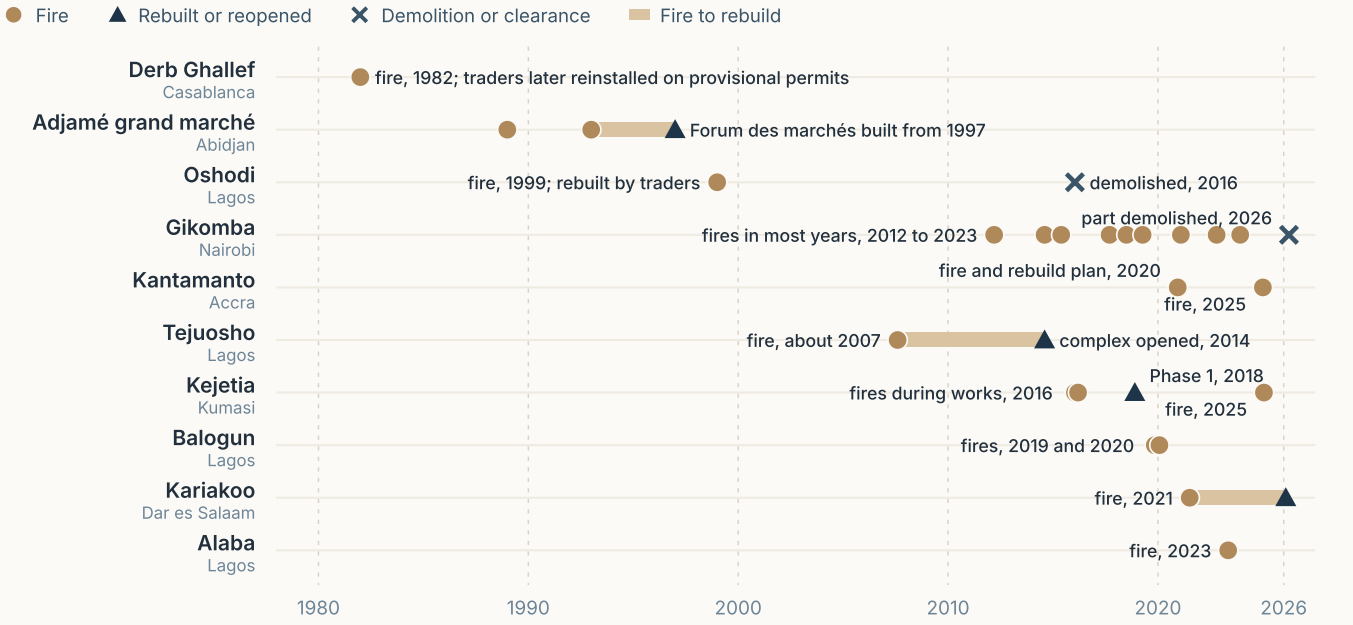
FIRE

Fire, more often than a plan, starts the rebuild

EXHIBIT 11

Six markets in the register were rebuilt or replanned after a fire; completed rebuilds took four and a half to seven years

Dated fires, rebuilds, plans and demolitions at selected markets, 1978 to 2026



Source: CESEM, Economia (2008); Université de Cocody (2009); Vanguard (2014, 2016, 2023); The Eastleigh Voice (2024); The Star (2026); Pulse Ghana (2020); MyJoyOnline (2025); WIEGO, Okoye (2020); Daily Graphic (2025); Channels TV (2019); Nairametrics (2020); Africanews (2026). Dates as reported; most rest on a single secondary source.

Fire runs through the record. Six markets in the register were rebuilt or replanned after a fire: Derb Ghallef, Adjamé, Oshodi, Tejuosho, Kantamanto and Kariakoo. Where both dates are published, the rebuild took four and a half to seven years: Kariakoo from its 2021 fire to its 2026 reopening, and Tejuosho from a fire about seven years before its new complex opened in 2014. At Adjamé, work on the Forum des marchés began in 1997, four years after the second fire.

Traders need somewhere to trade for those years. After Derb Ghallef's 1982 fire, a commission identified 730 former traders who needed a new site; a CESEM study counted 1,387 people working there in 2007.

At Kantamanto the fire came before the plan. A two-phase redevelopment announced after the December 2020 fire had not started when the market burned again in January 2025. Some fire protection has come from a non-profit: The Or Foundation says it has installed more than 500 fire extinguishers and paid over US$500,000 in grants to more than 1,500 Kantamanto traders since 2020.

KANTAMANTO, ACCRA: TWO COUNTS OF ONE FIRE

A fire on 2 January 2025 destroyed a large part of Kantamanto, a second-hand clothing market of nearly 30,000 traders, according to their association.

100+
shops razed, 3News, 2 Jan 2025, the day of the fire

7,000+
shops, MyJoyOnline, 23 Jan 2025, citing the traders' association

The two figures were reported three weeks apart by different sources. We show both and use neither as a total.

The government gave GH¢1m (about US$80,000 at the 2025 average rate) and The Or Foundation GHS1m. The association said it had agreed a US$100m loan with Access Bank to rebuild, and asked for help with disputes over the land, which a 2020 report placed under the Ministry of Railway Development.

A HEIRSTONE FRAMEWORK

Four routes for a market site, and five rules from the twelve projects

EXHIBIT 12

Rebuilding on the original site at market density is the only route with no reported loss of traders

Heirstone Market Redevelopment Typology, 1982 to 2026: projects placed by where traders trade after the works and the space they get

	On the original site	On another site, or none
	WHERE TRADERS TRADE AFTER THE WORKS	
Ground-level places at market density	**Rebuild dense, in place** ■ Forum des marchés, Abidjan: 13,000 places on 1.5 ha ■ Derb Ghallef, Casablanca: 1,387 people counted in 2007 **Working markets again; no loss of traders reported.**	**Relocate to a planned market** ■ Oshodi to Isopakodowo, Lagos: almost 600 shops ■ Agbogbloshie onion traders to Adjen Kotoku ■ Computer Village to Katangowa: stalled since 2017 **New sites never built, or no record of who moved.**
Lock-up shops, upper floors or nothing	**Formalise in place** ■ Kejetia, Kumasi: 8,420 spaces, 500 tables ■ Kariakoo, Dar es Salaam: six storeys, 1,500 return ■ Tejuosho, Lagos: 4,000+ lock-up shops, BOT lease **Shopkeepers kept; small traders squeezed or left outside.**	**Clear the site** ■ Agbogbloshie: cleared 2021; scrap workers back, 2025 ■ Toi, Nairobi: clearance planned 2018, still trading 2019 ■ Onitsha: c.10,000 shops, demolition planned 2026 **Trade returns informally where reports exist.**

Source: Heirstone analysis of the 12 projects in Exhibit 9. Gikomba (2026) and Kantamanto are not placed: their final designs are not public.

FIVE RULES FROM THE RECORD

1 **Count everyone before drawing anything.**
Design capacity to a full enumeration that includes tabletop and street vendors. Kejetia's plan provided 500 tables for about 5,000 street vendors; Gikomba enumerated 6,372 traders before its 2026 works began.

2 **Keep the trade on the ground.**
Put storage, parking and food courts below ground or upstairs, as Kariakoo's rebuild did with underground parking and a rooftop food court. Kejetia offered its street vendors tables on a first floor.

3 **Rebuild on the site, in phases.**
All three projects rebuilt on their own sites reopened as working markets. Seven of 25 surveyed Kejetia vendors stayed at their relocation site; the 25-hectare Katangowa site for Computer Village has not been built.

4 **Price stalls for the traders who are there.**
Oshodi's market leaders agreed to pay N5,000 a shop (about US$26) at Isopakodowo. Nairobi is paying relocated Gikomba traders' temporary rent of KSh1,500 a month during the works.

5 **Budget for years, not months.**
Kariakoo took four and a half years from fire to reopening, and Tejuosho's new complex opened about seven years after its fire. Plan interim trading space and fire protection for the whole period.



CHAPTER 4

04 Full, and worth less

Ikeja City Mall in Lagos reported vacancy of 2.1% or less between 2021 and 2024. From its 2019 valuation to the value implied by its 2024 sale, its worth in US dollars fell by about 40%.

The mall opened in December 2011 with about 23,000 m^2 of lettable space, anchored by Shoprite and a five-screen Silverbird cinema. Nike opened a flagship there in August 2022. Footfall held: Hyprop, which owned 75%, reported foot count down 1.5% in its 2024 financial year. Shoppers and tenants stayed while the value fell. Its rents were indexed to the US dollar, and the naira lost about 79% of its dollar value between 2019 and 2024, so tenants trading in naira carried a rising rent bill.

This chapter follows the Ikeja numbers, sets them against what happened to currencies across the continent, and reads published prime rents in that light. The lesson for owners is that occupancy is a poor guide to value wherever rent and sales are set in different currencies. The lesson for investors is that the exit can take years longer than planned.

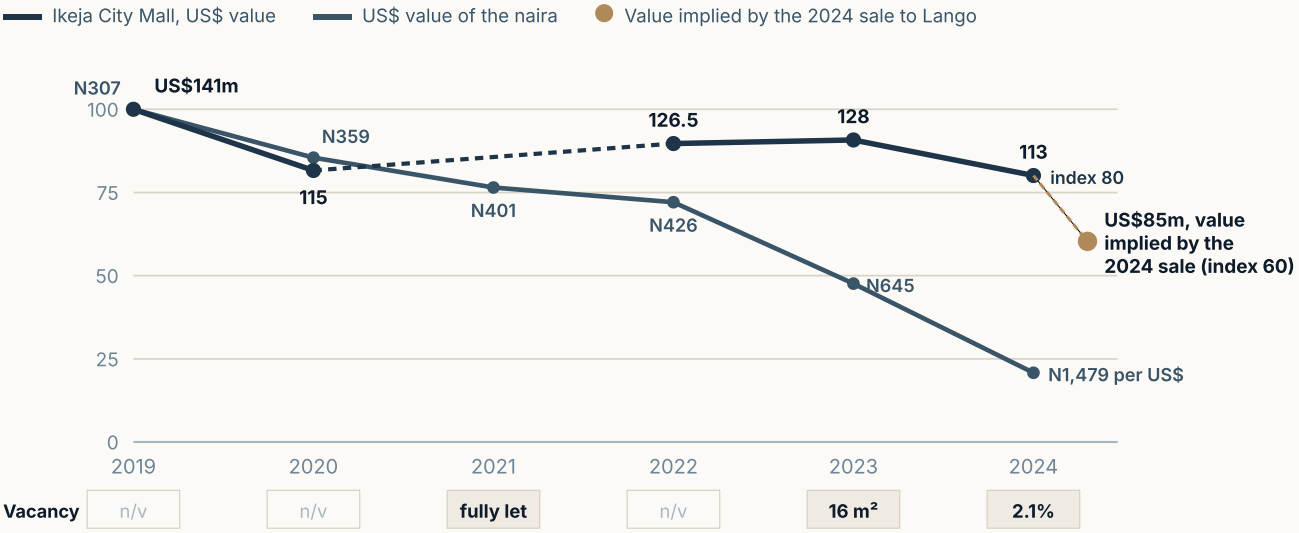
LAGOS AND ACCRA

The Lagos mall that stayed let and lost value

EXHIBIT 13

Ikeja City Mall stayed let while its dollar value fell 40% to the value implied by its 2024 sale; the naira lost 79% of its dollar value over the same years

Index, 2019 = 100. Mall: June valuations (labels in US$m). Naira: US$ value, annual average (labels: naira per US$). Vacancy at June.

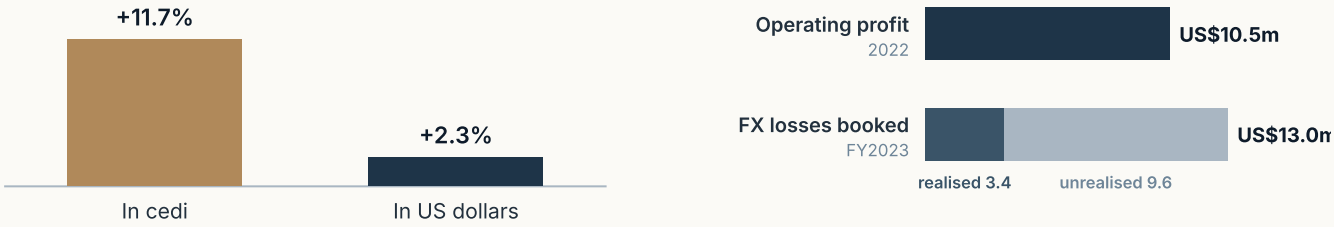


Source: Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2020 to FY2024; World Bank WDI, official exchange rate (PA.NUS.FCRF), accessed 2026. **Heirstone analysis.** The 2019 value is the valuation in force before June 2020; no valuation was found for June 2021; n/v = vacancy not reported in the sources used.

EXHIBIT 14

In FY2023, currency losses at Ikeja exceeded the mall's 2022 operating profit; in Ghana, tenants' sales grew five times as fast in cedi as in dollars

Left: tenants' turnover growth, Hyprop's Ghana malls, year to June 2024, %. Right: Ikeja City Mall, US$m.



Source: Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2022, FY2023 and FY2024. **Heirstone analysis:** FX losses = realised US$3.4m (R60m) + unrealised US$9.6m (R168m).

Hyprop's results booklets track the mall through the crisis. Ikeja City Mall was valued at US$141m before June 2020 and US$115m at June 2020, then recovered to US$128m by June 2023. In June 2024 it was independently valued at US$113m, and Hyprop cut its carrying value to R1.5bn (US$85m), the value implied by its sale to Lango Real Estate and 25% below the independent valuation.

Operations held up: operating profit rose from US$9.5m in 2021 to US$10.5m in 2022, an 8.7% yield on the US$121m agreed sale value at which Hyprop then carried the mall. The strain sat with tenants and cash. Hyprop reported in its 2023 financial year that the leases were indexed to the dollar, the naira had fallen 80% and tenants were struggling. It had been unable to secure dollars to remit income since December 2019.

Ghana shows the same effect in milder form. Tenants' turnover in Hyprop's Ghana malls rose 11.7% in cedi in the year to June 2024 and 2.3% in dollars. The gap between the two growth rates is the strain that dollar-linked rent puts on tenants.

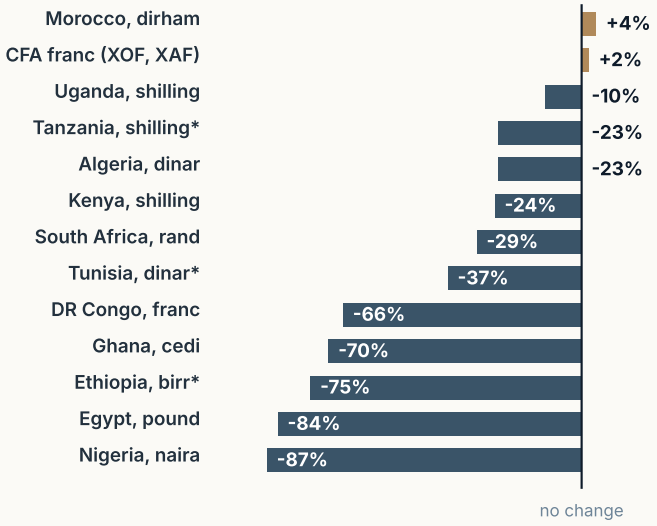
CURRENCIES AND RENTS

From 2015 to 2025 the naira lost 87% of its dollar value and the dirham gained 4%

EXHIBIT 15

Two of 13 currencies held their dollar value over the decade; the other 11 lost between 10% and 87%

Change in the US$ value of one unit of local currency, 2015 to 2025 annual averages, %. * 2015 to 2024.



Source: World Bank WDI, official exchange rate, LCU per US$, period average (PA.NUS.FCRF), accessed 2026. **Heirstone analysis.**

The World Bank's official rates show why the same lease produces different results across the continent. Between the 2015 and 2025 annual averages the Moroccan dirham gained 4% against the US dollar and the CFA franc 2%. The other 11 lost between 10% and 87%, the naira the most.

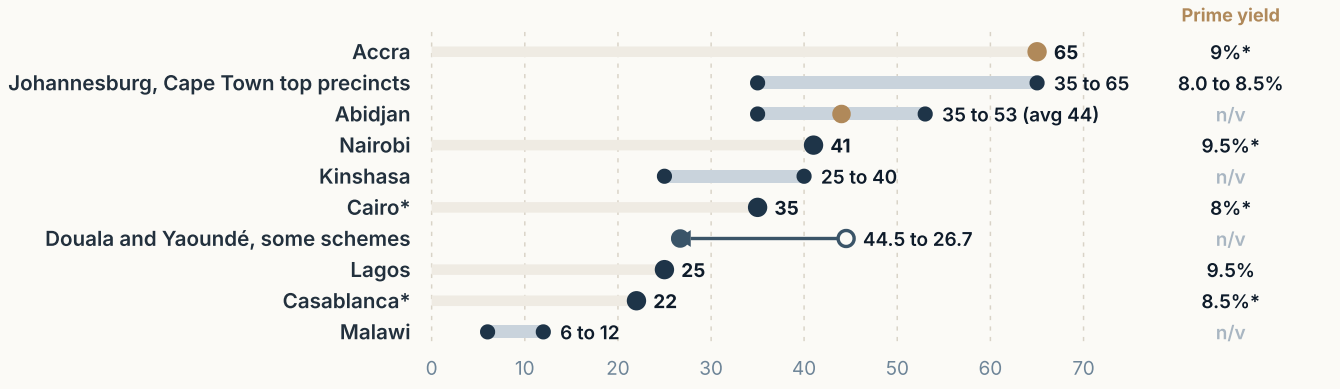
A dollar-indexed rent in Casablanca or Abidjan carries little currency risk for the tenant. Where the currency has fallen sharply, the same clause moves that risk onto tenants, and it comes back to the landlord through arrears and valuations.

A stable currency is not enough on its own. In Cameroon, a CFA franc economy, Knight Frank reports prime rents in some schemes softening from about US$44.5 to US$26.7 per m^2 a month, with mall vacancy around 30%, so anchor depth and spending power matter as much as the currency.

EXHIBIT 16

Accra's prime retail rent equals South Africa's best precincts and is 2.6 times Lagos'

Prime retail rent, US$ per m^2 per month, and prime yield, %, 2026. * Read from Knight Frank's country-page graphics (lower confidence).



Source: Knight Frank, The Africa Report 2026/2027 (7th edition): top prime rents per sector table, country text and country pages (*). Kinshasa range as stated in the country text.

Published prime rents need reading against supply as well as currency. Knight Frank ranks Accra joint first with South Africa's best precincts at US$65 per m^2 a month, while Accra's two largest malls add up to about 12 m^2 per 1,000 residents, against about 115 m^2 of mall space per 1,000 in Greater Cairo (Heirstone analysis). In a thinly supplied city a high prime rent may reflect scarce prime space as much as deep demand.

CHAPTER 5

05 When the anchor leaves

South African chains, the anchors of the first wave of malls outside South Africa, have pulled back. Franchisees, regional groups and local chains took most of the space.

5 years

for Hyprop to complete an exit from its malls outside South Africa that it planned in 2019 to finish in 12 to 18 months

64 to 5

Tuskys branches in Kenya in little over a year to 2021, as Nakumatt also failed

9

African countries where Shoprite trades, with more than 3,600 stores, according to its corporate website

The anchors of the first generation of malls beyond South Africa were South African chains. Between 2015 and 2025 most of them cut back.

Shoprite sold its Nigerian supermarket business, closed three of its stores in Kenya and left Uganda and Madagascar in 2021, according to The Africa Report, and left the DRC in 2022. Game, owned by Walmart's Massmart, left Ghana on 31 December 2022. Choppies, from Botswana, left South Africa, Mozambique, Kenya and Tanzania in 2020, and Pick n Pay handed its Namibian stores to a local brand in 2025. Shoprite's corporate website lists more than 3,600 stores in nine African countries.

Domestic chains fell too. In Kenya, Nakumatt, which had 62 branches in four countries at its peak, went from 60 branches in early 2017 to six in 2018, and its creditors voted to liquidate it in 2020. Tuskys went from 64 branches to five in little over a year to 2021. Uchumi had already closed its 11 loss-making outlets in Uganda and Tanzania in 2015.

Landlords left on a slower clock. Hyprop said in its 2019 financial year that it would sell its malls outside South Africa within 12 to 18 months, after the portfolio produced negative distributable income of R58m, which it attributed to weaker local currencies against the dollar and to South African retailers curtailing their operations. It impaired its investment in AttAfrica, owner of its Ghana malls, by R290m in 2020. The sale to Lango Real Estate was signed on 7 August 2024 and completed in September 2024, for Lango shares rather than cash, with the portfolio's dollar borrowings passing to the buyer.

The space did not stay empty for long. Majid Al Futtaim, the Dubai-based Carrefour franchisee, agreed to take over Shoprite's leases in Uganda. Naivas, which had 43 stores in 2017 and in 2020 took a US$15m minority investment from the IFC, part of a consortium with the private equity firm Amethis, bought Nakumatt's last six branches. In Ghana, Melcom, Decathlon and Orca Deco took Game's space within two years. Exhibit 17 sets out the moves; Exhibits 18 and 19 the Ghana case.

DEPARTURES AND SUCCESSORS

WHO LEFT	WHO TOOK THE SPACE OR THE MARKET
Shoprite, Uganda (2021)	Carrefour (Majid Al Futtaim) agreed to take over its leases
Nakumatt, Kenya (2017 to 2020)	Naivas bought its last six branches, 2019
Game, Ghana (2022)	Orca Deco (temporary) at Accra Mall; Melcom and Decathlon at all three Hyprop Ghana malls
H&M and Al Hokair, Morocco	Mango, Vans, Tommy Hilfiger, De Facto, Levi's, Costa Coffee at Anfa Place

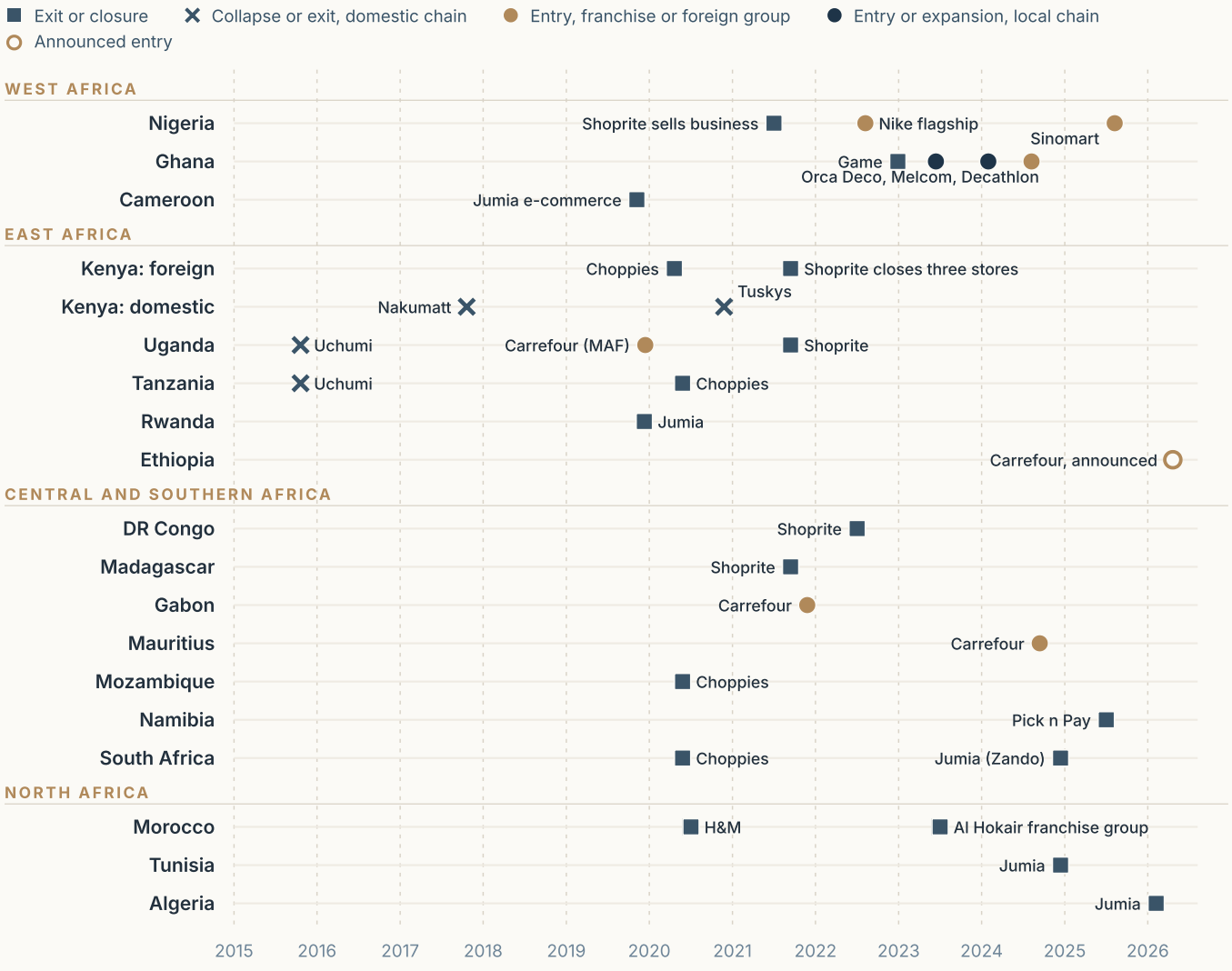
EXITS AND ENTRIES

Owned subsidiaries left; franchisees and local chains arrived

EXHIBIT 17

Between 2015 and 2026 Shoprite, Game, Choppies and Pick n Pay left ten countries between them; Carrefour franchisees opened in three and announced a fourth

Retailer and e-commerce exits, collapses and entries by country, 2015 to 2026. Dates as published; positions within a year approximate.



Source: Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2023 and FY2024; Grit Real Estate Income Group, Integrated Annual Report 2024; Jumia Technologies, Form 6-K (2024); The Africa Report (2021); Shoprite Holdings, Our story (2026); Choppies Group, History (2024); Namibia Economist (2025); Daily Nation (2019); Daily Monitor (2020); Citizen Digital (2021); Business Daily Africa (2015); The Washington Post (2019); The New Times (2019); Techpoint Africa (2026); The Independent, Uganda (2019); Carrefour Group (2021, 2026); Defimedia (2024); Knight Frank, The Africa Report 2026/27. Nike's exit from Ghana is reported without a date and is not shown.

The pattern is consistent across regions. The retailers that left were subsidiaries of a parent based elsewhere, mostly in South Africa, and their exits clustered in 2020 to 2022. The retailers that arrived were franchisees with local or regional capital: Majid Al Futtaim in Uganda, CFAO, which runs Carrefour stores in Côte d'Ivoire and Cameroon, and the Carrefour franchise holder GBH, which rebranded hypermarkets in Mauritius in 2024.

Franchising shifts the risk to the local partner: a mall's brand line-up then depends on that partner's balance sheet. H&M left Morocco in 2020 and the Saudi franchise group Al Hokair in 2023, emptying units at Casablanca's Anfa Place that Grit re-let to Mango, Vans, Tommy Hilfiger, De Facto, Levi's and Costa Coffee across more than 3,400 m².

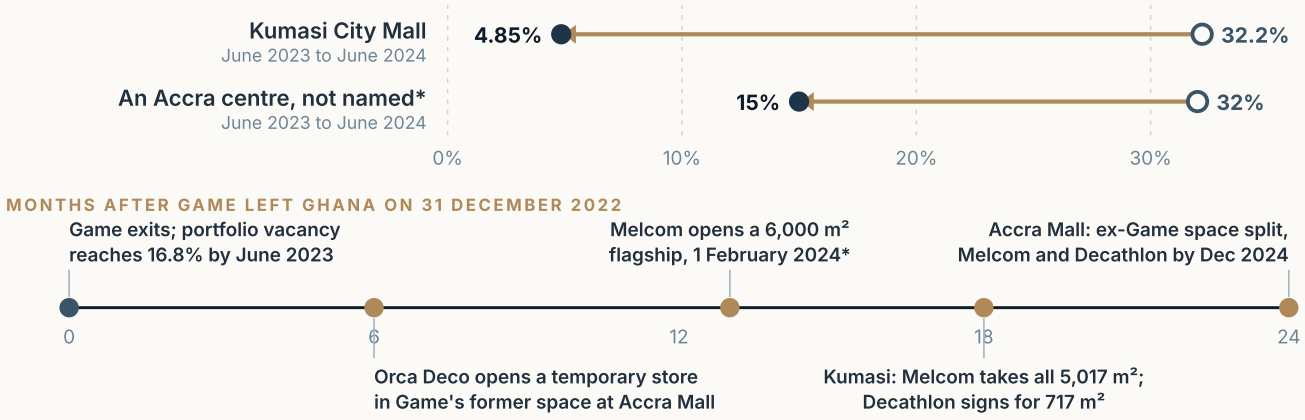
GHANA, 2023 TO 2024

Game left Ghana, and Ghanaian and French retailers took its space within two years

EXHIBIT 18

Vacancy at Kumasi City Mall fell from 32.2% to 4.85% in a year as a local chain fitted out the whole former anchor unit

Vacancy, % of lettable area (top); re-letting milestones in months after Game's exit (bottom)



Source: Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2023 and FY2024. * Hyprop's FY2024 text does not name the centre where Melcom opened its 6,000 m² flagship and vacancy fell from 32% to 15%; it is one of the two Accra malls. Game vacated 13,164 m² across the three Ghana centres.

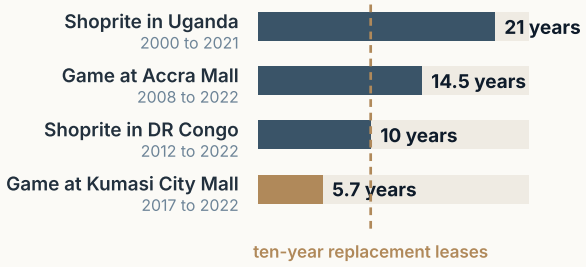
Game's departure is the best-documented anchor exit in the region, because the landlord's results record what followed. Game vacated 13,164 m² across Hyprop's three Ghana centres, and vacancy outside South Africa rose to 16.8% by June 2023. That month Orca Deco opened in Game's former space at Accra Mall. In February 2024 Melcom, a major Ghanaian retailer, opened a 6,000 m² flagship at a centre Hyprop does not name, where vacancy halved from 32% to 15%. At Kumasi City Mall, with Melcom fitting out the whole 5,017 m² Game unit, vacancy fell from 32.2% to 4.85% in a year.

Accra Mall took longer. Orca Deco's store was temporary, and the space was split between Melcom and Decathlon, due to trade by December 2024, two years after Game left. Game had traded at Kumasi City Mall for under six years, against the ten-year leases its replacements signed.

EXHIBIT 19

Game stayed less than six years at Kumasi City Mall

Years of presence, selected anchors and countries, 2000 to 2022



Source: Daily Monitor (2015); The Africa Report (2021); Shoprite Holdings, Our story (2026); Bloomberg (2012); Atterbury, Kumasi City Mall; Hyprop FY2023 and FY2024. **Heirstone analysis.**

A HEIRSTONE FRAMEWORK

The Heirstone Mall Viability Test

Five tests drawn from the evidence in this report. A new scheme should pass all five before it is financed. A standing mall that fails one carries a risk that its occupancy figure will not show.

1

CURRENCY

Rent in the money tenants take

Rent set in local currency, or dollar indexation capped. Fail if rent is dollar-linked and the local currency has lost more than half its dollar value over the past decade.

Evidence. Ikeja City Mall stayed at or below 2.1% vacancy while its dollar value fell 40% and the naira lost 79% (2019 to 2024). In Ghana, tenants' sales grew 11.7% in cedi and 2.3% in dollars. Over 2015 to 2025 the dirham gained 4% and the CFA franc 2%; the naira lost 87%.

2

ANCHOR DEPTH

Two takers for every box

At least two local or regional operators able to take each anchor unit within 18 months.

Evidence. In Ghana, Orca Deco, Melcom and Decathlon took Game's space within 6 to 24 months. In Uganda, Carrefour's franchisee agreed to take Shoprite's leases; in Kenya, Naivas bought Nakumatt's last six branches. In Nigeria the six leading chains run between 5 and 20-plus outlets each.

3

BOX SIZE

No box larger than a local chain can fill

Largest unit no bigger than local chains have taken whole, about 5,000 to 6,000 m^2 in Ghana, and built to divide.

Evidence. Melcom took the whole 5,017 m^2 Game unit at Kumasi City Mall and opened a 6,000 m^2 flagship at another Ghana centre. At Accra Mall the former Game space was let temporarily, then split between Melcom and Decathlon, with trading due about two years after Game left.

4

COST

Required rent well below prime

Capital cost per m^2 multiplied by the local yield and divided by 12 should be no more than about half the city's prime rent.

Evidence. Kumasi City Mall (2017) cost about US$5,300 per m^2 on its reported cost of US$95m for 18,000 m^2: about US$40 a month at a 9% yield, or 60% of Accra's US$65 prime rent, in a secondary city. Build costs are rarely published; Accra Mall's could not be verified.

5

FOOTFALL

Built on an existing flow of people

Site on or beside a market, a transport interchange or a dense neighbourhood, with room for market-format trade such as tables, food halls and wholesale.

Evidence. Warwick Junction sees about 460,000 people a day (Project for Public Spaces), against about 118,000 a day across Aradei's 35 assets. Grit reports that smaller malls with food and service tenants delivered results; Knight Frank reports neighbourhood formats outperforming large ones in Lagos.

Thresholds are Heirstone guides calibrated on the cases shown, not market standards. Exhibit 20 applies the test to seven malls and portfolios.

THE TEST APPLIED

Applied to seven malls, the test flags the one that lost value while full

EXHIBIT 20

The one clear currency failure lost value while staying full; in Ghana, Game's space was re-let within two years, the subdivided unit last

Heirstone Mall Viability Test applied to seven African malls and portfolios; outcomes as reported, 2019 to 2026

● Passes ○ Exposed or mixed ■ Fails □ Not verifiable from public sources

MALL	1 CURRENCY	2 ANCHOR DEPTH	3 BOX SIZE	4 COST	5 FOOTFALL	WHAT HAPPENED
Ikeja City Mall, Lagos 2011; 23,000 m²	■ Rent indexed to US$; naira lost 79%, 2019 to 2024	○ Shoprite sold its Nigerian arm, 2021; local chains small	□	□	□ Foot count fell 1.5%, FY2024	Vacancy 2.1% or less; US$ value down 40%; no US$ remittances from Dec 2019
Accra Mall 2008; 20,619 m²	○ Cedi lost 70%, 2015 to 2025; lease currency not published	● Orca Deco (temporary) in 6 months; then Melcom, Decathlon	○ Ex-Game space split	□ Build cost not verified	□	Ex-Game space let temporarily, then split; tenants due Dec 2024
Kumasi City Mall 2017; 18,000 m²	○ As Accra Mall	● Melcom and Decathlon, ten-year leases	● Whole ex-Game unit taken by a local chain	○ About US$40 needed, 60% of Accra prime	□ 2.5 km from the CBD	Vacancy 32.2% to 4.85%; Game stayed 5.7 years
West Hills Mall, Accra 2014; 27,700 m²	○ As Accra Mall	● Melcom and Decathlon, ten-year leases	□	□	□	Game's space re-let to Melcom and Decathlon
Anfa Place, Casablanca Grit portfolio	● Dirham gained 4%, 2015 to 2025	○ H&M (2020) and Al Hokair (2023) left Morocco	□	□	□	3,400 m² re-let to six brands; Grit retail 84.2% occupied, now non-core
Mall of Africa, Midrand 2016; 131,094 m²	● Rand rents and rand sales	● Woolworths, Checkers Hyper, Game: domestic chains	□	□	□	95.3% occupied, Jun 2026; trading density R4,880 per m² a month
Aradei Capital, Morocco 35 assets; 474,000 m²	● Dirham	● Linked to the grocer Label'Vie	□	□	□ 91 visits per m² a year	97% occupancy; 43 million visits, 2024

Source: Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2020 to FY2024; Attacq, annual results FY2026; Aradei Capital and Grit Real Estate Income Group disclosures; Atterbury; Pulse Ghana (2017); Bloomberg (2012); ThisDay (2011); University of Oxford thesis (2019); GNA via Citi FM (2017); Knight Frank 2026/27; World Bank WDI. **Heirstone analysis.**

Public data leave many cells blank, and the sample is small. No mall was left without tenants, though Game's exit left two Ghana centres about 32% vacant for a year. Ikeja, the one clear currency failure, stayed full and lost 40% of its dollar value. Mall of Africa and Aradei report the highest occupancy, 95% to 97%; Grit's retail portfolio, which includes Anfa Place, was 84.2% occupied, so currency alone does not decide.

Anchor departures were absorbed within six to 24 months where local or regional operators could take the space. Kumasi City Mall's whole Game unit went to one local chain within 18 months; Accra Mall's was let temporarily, then split. The cost test can be run only where a build cost is published, as at Kumasi City Mall; footfall is the test public data cannot yet answer.

1 of 7

malls in the sample with a clear currency failure; it stayed full and lost 40% of its dollar value

6 to 24

months for local and regional retailers to take the space Game left in Ghana

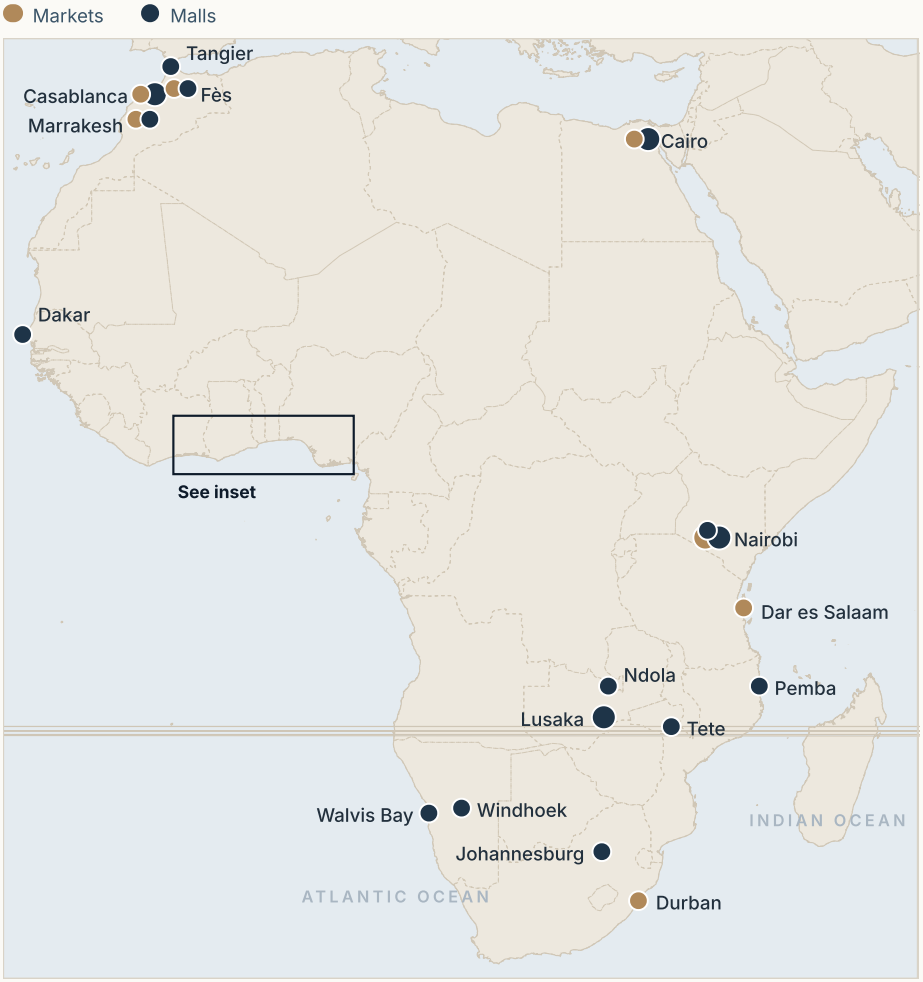
CHAPTER 6

North Africa, anglophone and francophone Africa

EXHIBIT 21

The register's markets cluster on the West African coast; its malls in North and Southern Africa

Heirstone Market and Mall Register, 2026: 20 markets and 27 malls by city. Circle size rises with the number of sites.

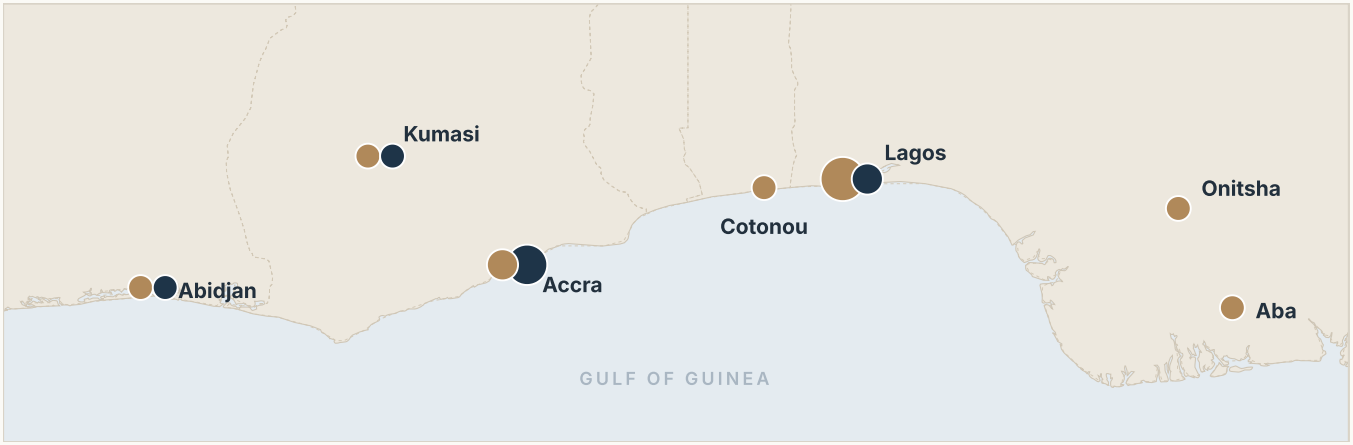


SITES BY REGION

	Mkts	Malls
North Africa	4	7
West Africa, anglophone	10	7
West and Central Africa, francophone	2	2
East Africa	3	3
Southern Africa	1	8
Total, 24 cities in 13 countries	**20**	**27**

The register is a record of what could be verified, not a census. Markets dominate the West African coast because that is where public reporting on them exists; the malls concentrate where listed landlords and developers publish portfolio data.

INSET: THE WEST AFRICAN COAST, ABIDJAN TO ABA



Source: Heirstone Market and Mall Register (2026); Natural Earth; city positions: OpenStreetMap (via Mapcarta). Sites plotted at city level; positions are approximate. Where a city has both, the market and mall circles are offset for legibility.

CITY BY CITY

Currency divides Africa's retail cities

EXHIBIT 22

Cities differ in channels and currency; Cairo's 2.6 million m² is the only citywide mall stock shown

Selected cities: currency change, channel shares, mall supply, prime rent, anchors and market redevelopment. n/v = not verified.

CITY	CURRENCY VS US$, 2015 TO 2025	CHANNEL SHARE (COUNTRY)	MALL SUPPLY	PRIME RENT, US$/M²/MO	FORMAL ANCHORS	MARKET SIGNAL
NORTH AFRICA						
Cairo	Pound −84%	Small grocers c.60%	c.2.6m m²; c.115 m² per 1,000	c.35*	Carrefour (MAF); IKEA	Ataba project, 2025
Casablanca	Dirham +4%	n/v	Aradei: 474,000 m² in Morocco	c.22*	Carrefour; Label'Vie	Derb Ghallef: 1,387 people (2007)
Tunis	Dinar −37%†	n/v	n/v	n/v	Jumia left 2024	n/v
WEST AFRICA: ANGLOPHONE						
Lagos	Naira −87%	Markets 72%; supermarkets 3%	One mall: c.1.4 m² per 1,000	25	Chains of 5 to 20+ outlets	Computer Village move stalled
Accra	Cedi −70%	Small grocers 83%	Two malls: c.12 m² per 1,000	65	Melcom, Decathlon, Orca Deco	Kantamanto fire, 2025
EAST AND SOUTHERN AFRICA						
Nairobi	Shilling −24%	n/v	Two malls: c.18 m² per 1,000	41	Naivas; Nakumatt and Tuskys failed	Gikomba rebuild, 2026
Dar es Salaam	Shilling −23%†	n/v	n/v	n/v	Uchumi, Choppies left	Kariakoo reopened, 2026
Johannesburg	Rand −29%	Supermarkets c.75%	Mall of Africa 95.3% let	35 to 65	Domestic chains	Warwick Junction, Durban
WEST AND CENTRAL AFRICA: FRANCOPHONE						
Abidjan	CFA franc +2%	Small grocers 63%; supermarkets 22%	n/v	35 to 53	Carrefour (CFAO); top four c.35%	Forum des marchés: 13,000 places
Dakar	CFA franc +2%	n/v	Sea Plaza (Casino)	n/v	Auchan	n/v
Douala	CFA franc +2%	n/v	Mall vacancy c.30%	26.7, from 44.5	Carrefour (CFAO)	n/v
Kinshasa	Franc −66%	n/v	n/v	25 to 40	Shoprite left, 2022	n/v

Source: World Bank WDI, PA.NUS.FCRF († 2015 to 2024); USDA FAS GAIN Retail Foods reports (2024); McKinsey (2015); Knight Frank, The Africa Report 2026/27 (* lower-confidence extraction); Aradei Capital; Attacq FY2026; retailer and press sources listed for chapter 5; Heirstone Market and Mall Register. **Heirstone analysis** for mall space per 1,000 residents (World Bank 2024 city populations).

Egypt. Greater Cairo's mall supply is the best documented in our data: about 2.6 million m² of lifestyle retail space across 82 developments, according to Knight Frank, about 115 m² per 1,000 residents (Heirstone analysis), with 183,730 m² delivered in 2025. Two of the best-known schemes are Gulf-developed: Majid Al Futtaim's Mall of Egypt, opened in 2017, and Al-Futtaim's Cairo Festival City Mall, opened in 2013 with Egypt's first IKEA, a 33,000 m² store, in a mixed-use development of more than three million m². Knight Frank puts Egypt's prime retail yield at about 8%, below the 9% to 9.5% it reports for Accra, Lagos and Nairobi. Small grocers hold about 60% of food retail, and in October 2025 the Prime Minister inaugurated the Ataba market development project, part of a programme to turn historic and informal markets into organised commercial centres.

Morocco. Aradei Capital, the listed landlord linked to the grocer Label'Vie, reports 474,000 m² across 35 assets in 23 cities, 97% occupancy and 43 million visits in 2024. Franchise exits are the visible risk: H&M left in 2020 and Al Hokair in 2023. The markets are the medinas. A renovation of Marrakesh's Jemaa el-Fna square budgeted at about MAD160m (about US$17m) began in 2025, according to Le360. In Casablanca, a CESEM study counted 1,387 people working at the Derb Ghallef flea market in 2007, where shops changed hands for 400,000 to 1.2 million DH.

Tunisia and Algeria. Public data are thin. Jumia left Tunisia at the end of 2024 and Algeria in 2026, when Algeria made up about 2% of its gross merchandise value. The Tunisian dinar lost 37% of its dollar value over 2015 to 2024.

SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

South of the Sahara the market leads and the mall works by exception

ANGLOPHONE AFRICA

Nigeria. Open-air markets carry 72% of retail sales and the six leading supermarket chains run about 90 outlets between them. State governments drive market redevelopment: Lagos at Computer Village, Oshodi and Tejuosho, Anambra at Onitsha, where about 10,000 shops were slated for demolition in February 2026. The mall evidence is Ikeja: full, dollar-indexed and worth 40% less in dollars. Prime rent is US$25 per m^2 a month at a 9.5% yield.

Ghana. Accra's prime rent of US$65 matches South Africa's best, on a thin stock of about 12 m^2 per 1,000 residents in its two largest malls. Ghanaian and French retailers absorbed Game's exit. Market redevelopment is capital-intensive and state-financed: Kejetia Phase 1 at US$198m to US$259m on published figures and Phase 2 launched in 2019 at €248m. At Kantamanto the traders' association says it has a US$100m bank loan to rebuild, subject to the land question.

Kenya. Two of the largest domestic chains failed, and Naivas bought the last branches of one of them. Knight Frank reports supermarket chains leading demand for new space, concentrated in neighbourhood malls. Nairobi's two largest malls, Two Rivers (67,000 m^2) and Garden City (33,000 m^2), add up to about 18 m^2 per 1,000 residents. Gikomba's 2026 rebuild, with a KSh5bn budget (about US$39m) and state-paid temporary rent, is the scheme to watch.

Tanzania and Southern Africa. Kariakoo reopened in 2026 after a 4.5-year rebuild in place. South Africa remains the exception, with supermarkets at about 75% of grocery and Mall of Africa 95.3% let. Atterbury's malls in Namibia and Mozambique, Grove Mall (52,772 m^2), Dunes Mall (32,438 m^2) and Pemba Shopping (6,859 m^2), use South African anchors; Pick n Pay's exit from Namibia in 2025 now puts the anchor test to Dunes Mall.

FRANCOPHONE AFRICA

Côte d'Ivoire. Small grocers hold 63% of food retail and supermarkets 22%; the informal sector accounts for about 75% of the market, even though the four largest chains take about 35% of retail revenues. In Adjamé, the Forum des marchés holds 13,000 places on 1.5 ha. CFAO's PlaYce malls each have a Carrefour store at their heart. Prime rents are XOF20,000 to 30,000 (US$35 to 53) per m^2 a month.

Senegal and Benin. In Dakar, Sea Plaza on the Corniche is anchored by a Casino supermarket and Auchan runs dozens of neighbourhood stores. Dantokpa in Cotonou, run by the state company SOGEMA, spreads over more than 20 hectares around a four-storey central building, and in 2017 the government planned to move its wholesalers to a new wholesale market at Calavi.

Cameroon and the DRC. Cameroon's malls run at about 30% vacancy and prime rents in some schemes have fallen from about US$44.5 to US$26.7 per m^2 a month, in a currency that held its value. Shoprite traded in the DRC from 2012 to 2022; the Congolese franc lost 66% of its dollar value between 2015 and 2025.

In the CFA franc economies the currency test has been passed over the past decade. The binding tests are anchor depth and spending power, and Adjamé's Forum des marchés, rebuilt at market density after two fires, is the strongest market record in our sample.

THE GULF'S ROLE

Capital and operators

Gulf groups are part of the African retail story as developers and franchisees. Dubai-based Majid Al Futtaim owns Mall of Egypt and holds the Carrefour franchise across the Middle East and North Africa; in East Africa it opened Carrefour in Uganda in 2019 and agreed to take over Shoprite's leases there. Al-Futtaim developed Cairo Festival City. The exit of the Saudi franchise group Al Hokair from Morocco in 2023 shows the same franchise exposure running the other way.

CHAPTER 7

07 What to do

Recommendations by audience, each tied to the evidence in chapters 1 to 6

CITY GOVERNMENTS AND MARKET AUTHORITIES

1 Count every trader before design.

Enumerate stall-holders, tabletop and street vendors, and publish the count. Kejetia's design gave about 5,000 street vendors 500 tables; Gikomba enumerated 6,372 traders before its 2026 works. Ground-level capacity should at least match the count.

2 Rebuild on the site, in phases.

All three projects in our record that were rebuilt in place reopened as working markets. Relocation sites lost traders (seven of 25 surveyed Kejetia vendors stayed) or were never built (Katangowa, proposed in 2017).

3 Keep trade on the ground, at market density.

The Forum des marchés holds 13,000 places on 1.5 ha. Use upper floors and basements for storage, parking, offices and food, as Kariakoo did with underground parking and a rooftop food court.

4 Protect the fee base and fund the interim.

Model toll income through construction: street-vendor tolls were estimated at 70% of Kumasi's own revenue. Nairobi's payment of temporary rent for Gikomba traders, KSh1,500 (about US$12) a month, is worth evaluating as a template.

5 Make fire safety the first phase.

Six of the redevelopments in our register followed fires, and completed rebuilds took four and a half to seven years. Extinguishers, access and electrical safety cost little against that delay; The Or Foundation has installed more than 500 extinguishers at Kantamanto.

MALL DEVELOPERS AND OWNERS

6 Pass the currency test.

Set rent in local currency, or cap the dollar indexation and share the currency risk with tenants explicitly. Ikeja City Mall shows the alternative: full, and 40% lower in dollar value.

7 Size anchor boxes for local chains.

Keep the largest unit within what local operators have taken whole, about 5,000 to 6,000 m^2 in Ghana, with structure and services designed for subdivision. Accra Mall's former Game space took two years to re-let permanently, as two units.

8 Line up the second anchor before signing the first.

In Ghana, Orca Deco, Melcom and Decathlon filled Game's space within 6 to 24 months. Where no local chain of scale exists, as in Nigeria, where the largest chains run 5 to 20-plus outlets, size the scheme to that fact.

9 Build on the market's flow of people.

Locate beside markets and transport and include market-format space: tables, food halls, wholesale. Kariakoo's rebuild added parking for 400 cars and a rooftop food court; Kejetia combined a market with a lorry terminal.

RETAILERS AND CONSUMER GOODS COMPANIES

10 Distribute through markets.

Open-air markets carry 72% of Nigerian retail sales and small grocers 83% of Ghanaian food retail. Route-to-market plans need market wholesalers and traders' associations as named partners.

11 Enter through franchise or local capital, and check the partner.

Carrefour's franchisees kept opening as owned subsidiaries withdrew, and Naivas took Nakumatt's last branches with private equity and DFI backing. The franchise partner's balance sheet then becomes the risk, as H&M's and Al Hokair's exits from Morocco showed.

12 Favour smaller, grocery-led formats near homes and markets.

Grit reports results from smaller malls with food and service tenants; Knight Frank reports neighbourhood formats outperforming large ones in Lagos and supermarket-anchored neighbourhood malls leading demand in Kenya.

INVESTORS, DEVELOPMENT FINANCE INSTITUTIONS AND LENDERS

13 Stress the currency before the occupancy.

Underwrite dollar returns against the past decade's currency path. From 2015 to 2025 that path ran from a 4% gain for the dirham to an 87% fall for the naira. A full mall can still lose 40% of its dollar value.

14 Budget for slow, non-cash exits.

Hyprop planned an exit of 12 to 18 months and took five years. It was paid in Lango shares, at a carrying value 25% below independent valuation, and could not remit dollars from Lagos from December 2019.

15 Back operating platforms.

Operators grew where malls struggled: the IFC put US$15m into Naivas in 2020, and Carrefour franchise networks, including those of Majid Al Futtaim and CFAO, kept opening as owned subsidiaries left.

16 Finance market rebuilds with trader-retention conditions.

Market rebuilds already draw sovereign and bank finance: a Brazilian government loan for Kejetia's first phase, Deutsche Bank for its second, and at Kantamanto a US$100m Access Bank loan reported by the traders' association. Lenders can tie drawdowns to enumeration, on-site phasing and ground-level capacity that matches the pre-works count.

TESTS TO WATCH IN 2026 AND 2027

Gikomba, Nairobi. How many of the 6,372 enumerated traders return to the rebuilt market, and at what fee.
Onitsha. Whether the planned demolition of about 10,000 shops proceeds, and where the trade goes.
Kantamanto, Accra. Whether the land question is settled and the US$100m rebuild loan the traders' association reported is drawn.
Ataba, Cairo. How many existing traders take space in the developed market, and on what terms.
Kariakoo, Dar es Salaam. How far the rebuilt market's 1,500 returning traders grow back towards the wider district's trade.
Dunes Mall, Walvis Bay. Who takes Pick n Pay's space after its 2025 exit from Namibia.
Lango's malls. Whether the new owner of Ikeja City Mall and the Ghana malls publishes values and occupancy.
Carrefour in Ethiopia. Whether the entry Carrefour announced in 2026 opens stores.

WHERE THE EVIDENCE RUNS OUT

Site areas, trader counts and turnover are published for very few of the continent's largest markets; the register shows n/v more often than a number. No citywide mall stock was found for Lagos, Nairobi, Accra or Abidjan, so our per-capita figures for those cities count named malls only.

Lease currency is disclosed for one mall in our sample. Kejetia Phase 2, the Kantamanto rebuild, Gikomba and Onitsha were all unresolved at the time of writing. These are the measurements that would most improve decisions on African retail real estate, and city governments are best placed to publish them.

NOTES, METHOD AND SOURCES

Definitions

Trading unit: a stall, table, place, shop or store as counted by the source. **Market:** a traditional or open-air market, covered or not, usually on public land. **Mall:** a purpose-built shopping centre let to retail tenants. **GLA:** gross lettable area. **Lifestyle GLA:** Knight Frank's measure of Cairo's organised retail stock. **Dollar-indexed lease:** rent set or adjusted by reference to the US dollar. **n/v:** not verified in public sources; not zero.

Redevelopment outcomes (Exhibit 9): rebuilt in place, reopened as a working market on the original site; rebuilt as lock-up shops, a market rebuilt mainly as lock-up units, with or without room for tabletop and street traders; moved or cleared, traders relocated or the site cleared; stalled, announced but not built; pending, under way in 2026.

Method

Heirstone Market and Mall Register: 47 named sites (20 markets, 27 malls) in 24 cities and 13 countries, each with at least one figure verified in a public source. Positions are at city level, from OpenStreetMap.

Heirstone Market Redevelopment Record: 12 projects at register markets with a public record of what happened to traders; outcome classes are our classification.

Derived measures (Heirstone analysis): units per hectare = units ÷ site area (malls: ÷ GLA); capital per trading unit = reported cost ÷ units; mall space per 1,000 residents = GLA ÷ World Bank 2024 largest-city population (Cairo 22.6m, Lagos 16.5m, Nairobi 5.5m, Accra 3.9m) or Morocco's urban population (23.9m); required rent = cost per m² × yield ÷ 12; currency change = 2015 average rate ÷ 2025 average rate, minus one.

Exchange rates: World Bank official rate, local currency per US$, annual average for the year of the figure; 2025 averages for 2026 figures. Selected rates: NGN 192.4 (2015), 305.8 (2017), 1,479.0 (2024); GHS 8.27 (2022), 12.56 (2025); KES 129.3 (2025); TZS 2,597.9 (2024); MAD 9.35 (2025); ZAR 17.89 (2025); XOF 581.9 (2025).

Mall Viability Test: thresholds are Heirstone guides calibrated on the cases shown, not market standards.

Source grades: A, primary filings and official data; B, named press or broker reports; C, a single secondary source, mostly press reports, dissertations and single studies. Grade C figures are attributed in the text.

Conflicts: Kantamanto fire damage, over 100 shops (3News, 2025) against over 7,000 (traders' association, 2025): both shown. Kariakoo cost, TSh28bn against US$10m: consistent at the 2024 rate (about US$10.8m); US$10m used. Toi's plot, three acres (The Standard, 2018) against four (The Star, 2019): range shown. Kumasi City Mall, 61 shops (Atterbury) against 74 (GNA, 2017): Atterbury used. Kejetia Phase 1 cost, US$198m (Graphic Online, 2015) against US$259.4m (Graphic Online, 2019): range shown. Hyprop does not name the Ghana centre whose vacancy fell from 32% to 15%. Knight Frank figures marked * come from country-page graphics; unconfirmed ones were omitted.

Sources by chapter

1. USDA FAS GAIN Retail Foods reports for Nigeria, Ghana, Côte d'Ivoire, Egypt and South Africa (2024); McKinsey (2015); Aradei Capital; Rural Electrification Agency; Peoples Gazette; Ghanaian Times; Project for Public Spaces; WIEGO; Vanguard; Fashion Dive; Reuters via Fin24; The Eastleigh Voice; Citizen Digital; Daily Nation; Daily Monitor.

2. Université de Cocody (2009); The Standard; The Star; Wanted in Africa; Pulse Ghana; Bloomberg; Atterbury; GNA via Citi FM; Graphic Online; FAO and CIRAD (1998); Benin Ministry of Decentralisation; Beninsite; CESEM, Economia (2008); UNESCO; Le360; Sahara Reporters; Channels TV; Nairametrics; MyJoyOnline; Africanews; Pan African Visions; Markets of Warwick; Egypt Independent.

3. As chapter 2, with the Presidency of Ghana; 3News; Ghana News Agency; Daily Graphic; Citinewsroom; muntaka.com; Kenyans.co.ke.

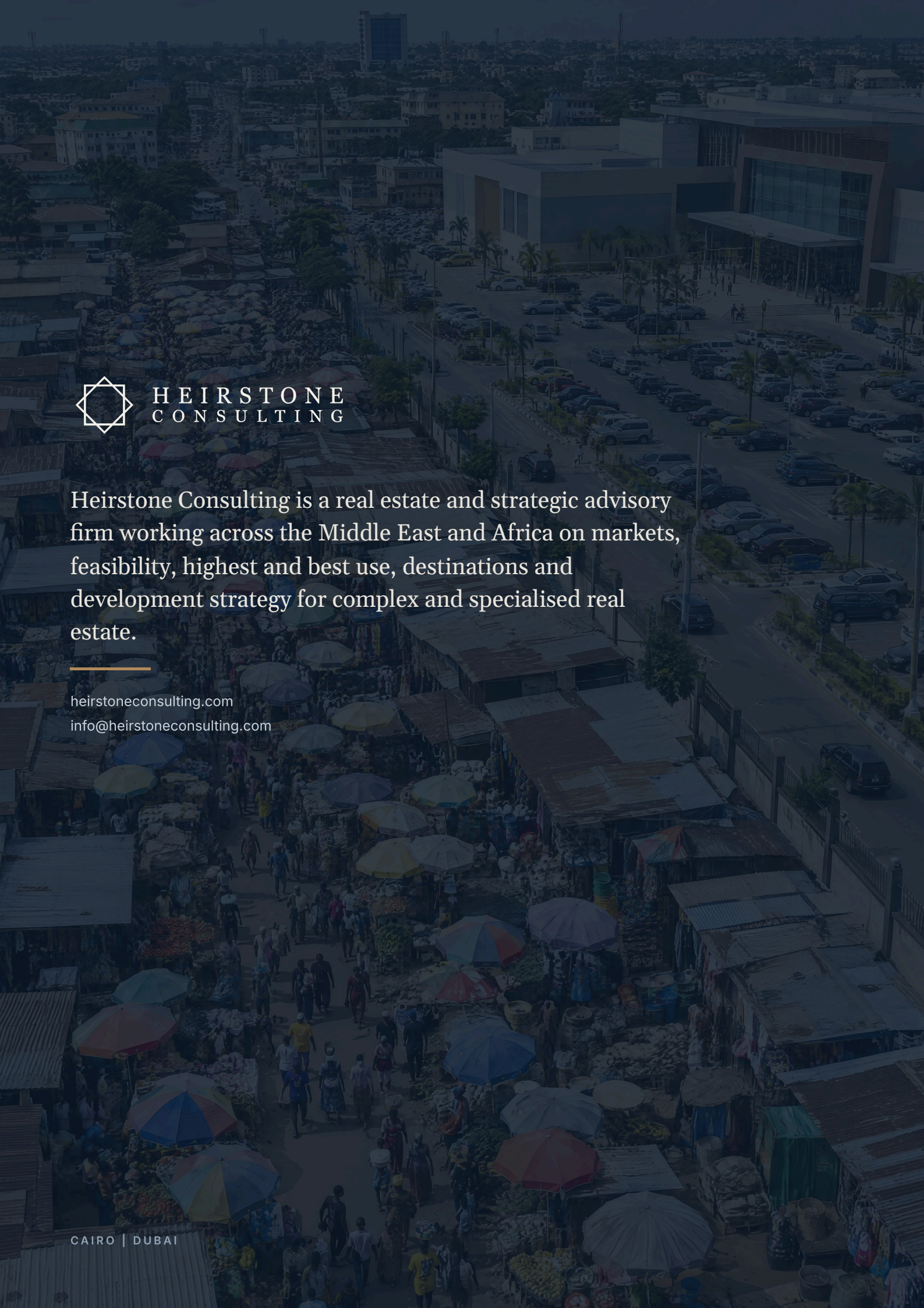
4. Hyprop Investments, annual results booklets FY2019 to FY2025; World Bank WDI, PA.NUS.FCRF (accessed 2026); Knight Frank, The Africa Report 2026/2027.

5. Hyprop; Attacq; Grit Real Estate Income Group; Aradei Capital; Atterbury; Jumia Technologies, Form 6-K (2024); The Africa Report (2021); Shoprite Holdings; Daily Monitor; Daily Nation; Business Daily Africa; Citizen Digital; Choppies Group; Namibia Economist; Forbes; The Washington Post; The New Times; Techpoint Africa; The Independent (Uganda); Carrefour Group; Defimedia; CFAO; Capital FM; Construction Kenya; ThisDay; University of Oxford thesis (2019).

6. As above, with Egypt Independent; Forbes; Ahram Online; Le Matin; Le360; CESEM; Natural Earth; OpenStreetMap via Mapcarta.

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